Yet strangely enough, Kumārila who advocates the theory of 'Svataḥpramāṇatva,' in Sūtra II of his 'Ślokavārtikā later on turns out to be an opponent of the theory of self-luminosity of cognitions later in the 'Suryavāda' of the same Vārtikā. His criticism of self-illuminancy of cognitions is unsatisfactory, halfhearted, and unspirited. No serious argument is advanced except the analogy that cognition is like the light in the eye which only illumines other objects but not itself. Just as it is not in the power of the eye to illumine itself, so is the case with cognitions also.

We have considered in detail elsewhere the inappropriateness of the analogy of the eye and the cognition and have also shown the difficulties of a theory of non-self-luminosity.[2] The point here is to consider if one can reasonably hold the theory of the intrinsic validity of cognitions and in the same breath deny the theory of intrinsic cognizability of cognitions.

It seems clear that what is not intrinsically cognized cannot be established as intrinsically valid also, for, what is dependent for its cognizability upon later cognitions and inferences, cannot guarantee its own validity which can then be only extrinsic, and due to external conditions. If the intrinsic validity of cognitions is to be admitted, in order to avoid an infinite regress, the same must also be the case with the intrinsic cognition of cognitions. Kumārila admits that if validity did not belong to the cognitions inherently and intrinsically, validity could not be stamped on the cognitions from outside. Exactly the same must be said with regard to cognizability too. If cognizability did not belong to the cognitions intrinsically and inherently at the very first stage, it could not at any later stage be added to it.

Cognitions are either cognized or uncognized, and if they are cognized, it is far more satisfactory to hold that they are immediately cognized than subsequently cognized. We cannot maintain the view that cognitions are uncognized, for in the first place, it would be absurd to maintain that objects are cognized without the cognition being cognized, and secondly, all systems of thought agree in holding that the cognitions *are* cognized by *some* means and at *some* stage.

If the above analysis of the relationship of the two concepts of the self-cognizability, and self-validity is correct, the question is, why did Kumārila contradict himself? It seems that Kumārila has been inadvertently led to a criticism of 'Svaprakāsa vāda' in his chapter on 'Suryavāda' by the force of an overpowering anxiety to combat the 'Vijnānavāda' theory of the essential sameness of the subject and the object of knowledge. It is generally feared that the concept of self-illuminancy of consciousness on the theory